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# GREENLAND RECREATION AFTER SCHOOL PROGRAM

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PARENT MANUAL 2026 (July)

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# GRASP PARENT HANDBOOK

## What is GRASP?

GRASP (Greenland Recreational After-School Program), is a community-based, non-profit corporation which operates a school age Childcare Program monitored by a Volunteer Board of Directors. The program has been in operation since 1985 and is located at Greenland Public School. Although priority is given to students from Greenland Public School, children from neighbouring schools are also eligible for inclusion in the program. The focus of GRASP is to work in harmony with the family, the community, and the school to provide an enriched, stimulating and safe environment for the children. The program includes arts and crafts and a wide range of indoor and outdoor activities. The program is designed to meet the needs of children and ensure that children not only acquire new skills, but also form a positive self-image.

GRASP was enrolled been approved for the Canada Wide Early Learning Child Care (CWELCC) program established in 2022. This provided all families with quality and affordable childcare. The “Centre” reviews and assess the program requirements annually and may be subject to any new information or changes provided by the Ministry of Education and other governing bodies. GRASP abides and follows CWELLC guidelines.

Based on the 2025 guidelines, GRASP will no longer be eligible to participate in CWELLC.

- Licensees that operate exclusive programs for the 6-12 age group, will have their CWELCC funding end on December 31, 2024, along with the related Service Agreement schedules. There is no change to fee subsidy for licensees that operate exclusive programs for the 6-12 age group fees

## PROGRAM STATEMENT

### Our Mission

GRASP is committed to providing affordable non-profit childcare to our community through quality programing and qualified staff. Our mandate is to provide high-quality childcare to our community, which is designed through pedagogy in a nurturing, child-focused environment at its core.

***How Does Learning Happen?*** Ontario's pedagogy for the early years is the foundation for our program. Pedagogy is the understanding of how learning takes place and the philosophy and practices that support that understanding. Children succeed in programs that focus on active learning through exploration, play and inquiry. Children are competent, capable, curious and rich in potential and thrive in programs where they and their families are valued as active participants and contributors.

| <b><i>Foundations</i></b> | <b>Goals for Children</b>                                                                                   | <b>Expectations for Program</b>                                                                                                                 |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Belonging</i>          | Every child has the sense of belonging when he/she is connected to others and contributes to his/her world. | Cultivate respectful relationships and connections to create a sense of belonging among and between children, adults and the world around them. |
| <i>Well-Being</i>         | Every child is developing a sense of self and health and well-being.                                        | Nurture children's healthy development and support their growing sense of self.                                                                 |
| <i>Engagement</i>         | Every child is an active and engaged learner who explores the world with her/his senses, bodies and minds.  | Provide environments and experiences to engage children in active, creative and meaningful exploration and learning.                            |
| <i>Expression</i>         | Every child is a capable communicator who is able to express himself/herself in many ways.                  | Foster communication and expression in all forms.                                                                                               |

Our programs are fluid in design with activities to suit each child's needs through child initiated and staff supported experiences. We believe that children of all ages should have a pedagogy choice. Founded on this principal, the intent is to strengthen the quality of programming and ensure high-quality experiences that lead to a positive outcome for the children's learning, development, health and wellbeing which aligns with How Does Learning Happen?

## **GOALS and APPROACHES**

### **A. Promote the health, safety and well-being of children, families and educators.**

Patterns of eating and physical activity that are established in early childhood continue into later life.

- Children are signed in and out daily, arrival and departure times are recorded.
- Children are never left unattended.
- Adults having contact with children have a completed police reference check.
- Snacks menus are approved by a certified nutritionist annually, based on Canada's Food Guide, are posted in all rooms used by GRASP.
- Food that can be brought into the center is restricted in order to protect children that have allergies.
- Educators create positive eating environments with foods and portion sizes that are responsive to children's cues and hunger and fullness.
- Food restrictions are accommodated in partnership with families and caterers.
- Children are monitored for symptoms of ill health and parents are informed promptly.
- GRASP has installed a security system for access after school hours.
- All staff are CPR level C and First Aid trained.

### **B. Support positive and responsive interactions among the children, parents, childcare providers and staff**

GRASP encourages positive and responsive interactions among children, parents and staff. Families are experts on their own children and deserve to be engaged in a meaningful way that allows them to feel that they belong and are valued as GRASP families. Gaining knowledge about children from multiple perspectives helps ensure that programs also value the unique and diverse characteristics of the children's families and the communities in which they live.

- Children and families are greeted every morning and children experiencing separation anxiety are comforted.
- Children's emotions are acknowledged and respected by allowing choices and room for quiet reflection.
- Families are encouraged to share in their traditions and celebrations by participating in group sharing, lending items or photos that reflect their ethnicity.
- GRASP provides social and educational opportunities for families and educators to build on positive relationships.

### **Strategies to Support and Strengthen Positive Interactions**

Educators, children and parents are co-learners building on knowledge together. When we recognize and build on the strength of families and the love they have for their children, everyone benefits.

- Educators engage, observe and listen to children and families to build on their strengths by daily communications.
- We have an open-door policy and encourage on going communication to express thoughts and feeling about the program and their children in a respectful and responsible way.
- The orientation process provides an opportunity for families to share initial information.
- Educators discuss with each other and families the possibilities for children's further exploration in increasingly complex ways and use this information to plan for meaningful environments that support learning.

### **C. Encourage the children to interact and communicate in a positive way and support their ability to self-regulate**

Our staff creates engaging environments and experiences that foster positive interactions and encouraging ongoing communication among all children while keeping in mind their ability to self-regulate and individual needs. Self-regulation is about how a child is able to deal effectively with stressors and then recover. Educators support children's developing ability to self-regulate by being responsive and attuned to children's individual cues, arousal states, and responses to various stressors.

- Children's emotional responses are acknowledged and respected.
- Children are encouraged to express their emotions by staying calm and modulating their impulses.
- Educators support children to resolve conflicts in a positive constructive manner.
- Educators capitalize on daily routines such as snack times and group meetings to make connections and provide opportunity for communication.
- Educators facilitate communication between children, modeling listening strategies to support relationships.
- Educators provide environments that reduce stressors and support children's efforts.
- Children are encouraged to be aware of the effect of their actions on others.

### **Foster the children's exploration, play and inquiry; Evidence from diverse fields of study tells us that when children are playing, they are learning**

Through play and inquiry, young children practice ways of learning and interacting with the world around them that they will apply throughout their lives. Playrooms are planned to allow for children to move freely from area to area.

- Educators, as co-learners, engage with children, planning, participating, and learning approaches that support developing skills.
- The environment fosters children's natural curiosity by providing materials that engage the child's body, mind, and senses.
- Toys are open ended to allow for creative use and exploration.
- A large variety of toys and materials are accessible to encourage children to investigate through play.

### **Supporting Healthy Development and Learning**

- Environments are created that recognize children are individual by documenting their learning.
- Providing quiet activities for children who do not sleep.
- Connecting with families to ensure environments and experiences reflect the child's everyday life.

### **D. Plan for and create positive learning environments and experiences;**

Children are active rather than passive participants in their own learning process and are competent, capable and curious individuals with rich potentials. Understanding that each child develops at their own rate, we foster the child's exploration and inquirer through play. Children grow up in families with diverse social, cultural and linguistic perspectives, knowing this we make it an integral part of our program to ensure each child feels that they belong at GRASP and that they are a valuable contributor to our program with the opportunity to succeed.

- Child initiated experiences can be seen on photo documentation boards in each classroom.
- Some emergent experiences are documented as they occur and posted.
- Child initiated play can be seen regularly as we observe how children use their environment.

Every GRASP staff should feel that they belong, and they are an integral and valuable contributor of our program. All staff deserves the opportunity to engage in meaningful work.

- Our weekly program plans are developed through observations and incorporate positive learning opportunities and experiences that allows for supported learning environment.
- Educators set up the environment to engage the child's interest and curiosity.

**E. Plan for and create positive learning environments and experiences in which each child's learning and development will be supported;**

When educators have an understanding of child development, they are able to provide experiences that challenge children to stretch just beyond what they know and can do.

- Two observations of each child are recorded monthly to provide a basis for programming that is meaningful.
- Documentation helps educators to find meaning in what children do and explore ways to engage them.
- Planned activities support social, emotional, physical, creative, cognitive and language development.
- Educators use ELECT as a resource to understand the sequence of development to plan for children's learning.

**F. Incorporate indoor and outdoor play, as well as active play, rest and quiet time, into the day, and give consideration to the individual needs of the children receiving childcare;**

Children thrive in indoor and outdoor spaces that invite them to investigate, imagine, think, create, solve problems and make meaning from their experiences. GRASP incorporates on a daily basis time for indoor and outdoor play, as well as quiet and active opportunities, while taking into consideration the individual child and their needs

- Children daily schedule's, plans for all of the above activities and play times.
- Where possible, active play areas and quiet areas are located at opposite ends of the room and playground.

**G. Foster the engagement of and ongoing communication with parents about the program and their children**

A shared view of families as competent and capable, curious and rich in experience informs our relationship with families and has a significant impact on children.

Educators engage in reciprocal relationships with families, learning about, with and from them. Educators share their professional knowledge and experiences and also seek out the knowledge and perspectives of families.

- Ongoing photo displays provide families with a sense of involvement and belonging.
- Educators engage in daily communication with families through verbal engagement.
- Annual program newsletters are used to share information about events and other information.
- Families are requested to complete an annual survey to provide feedback on all aspects of the program.
- Email communications with parents are sent out as reminders, share workshop information and community events.

**H. Involve local community partners and allow those partners to support the children, their families and staff**

Opportunities to engage with people, places, and the natural world in the local environment help children, families and educators, and communities build connections. GRASP seeks involvement from our local community partners and allow them to support our program, parents and staff.

- Children visit local business that may relate to the program and their interest.
- Regular visit to the local library to use the facilities and check out books.
- Children visit the Greenland Public School office, library and take walks around the school hallways.
- Local firefighters are invited to visit in the summer.
- Local dental offices and Toronto Public Health workers are made use of to share information with families.
- Use of a variety of local parks weekly over the summer.
- Weekly trips in the summer and non-instructional days.

**I. Support staff, home childcare providers or others who interact with the children at a childcare centre or home childcare premises in relation to continuous professional learning**

We support our staff at GRASP by seeking out continuous professional learning opportunities and embracing by considering opportunities present to us. We believe our staff are knowledgeable, caring, resourceful and they too bring diverse social, cultural and linguistic perspectives. Educators are lifelong learners. Our staff are rich in experiences, competent and capable individuals that collaborate with others to create engaging environments and experiences. When educators engage in continuous learning and questioning, exploring new ideas and adjusting practices, they achieve the best outcomes for children, families and themselves.

- Educators are provided with learning opportunities by participating in workshops, staff meetings, City of Toronto ongoing quality assessment training and collaborating with other educators.
- GRASP financially supports staff who enroll in a recognized Early Childhood Education Program, as per our Staff development Policy.
- Educators are provided with resources that promote and support children's learning.
- Educators establish goals in conjunction with the Director during evaluations.
- Educators are provided with planning time away from the children.

**J. Document and review the impact of the strategies set out in clauses (a) to (j) on the children and their families**

Early years curriculum is the sum total of experiences, activities and events that occur within an inclusive environment designed to foster children's well-being, learning, and development and ensure meaningful participation for every child.

- The Board of Directors will review the impact and implementation of our statement on the children, their families and our community annually.
- The Program Statement will be modified as new strategies and ideas are incorporated and updated.
- The director will be able to re-evaluate The Program Statement through exit interview annual surveys.
- Staff meeting and building positive relationship with families the children and our community to encourage dialog.
- Educators will be able to re-evaluate and revisit The Program Statement regularly during monthly staff meetings.

GRASP is committed to continuous improvement and our Program Statement is a fluid document reviewed and amended to meet the needs of children, families and educators.

GRASP Program Statement is reviewed annually with all educators/staff or at such time the Program Statement is modified. Staff, students and volunteers review the Program Statement prior to interacting with the children.

### **The Board of Directors (“BOD”)**

The GRASP Board of Directors oversees the operation and financial viability of GRASP and has the option to make decisions, changes and/or additions to the policies, procedures, and financial operation of the program as the need arises.

To comply with the Bylaws of the Corporation and Board of Education Policy, the GRASP Board of Directors must consist of a minimum of five (5) Board Members including Executive Members, which will be: Chair, Vice Chair, Treasurer and Secretary. Board Members usually serve a two-year term and receive no remuneration for their services. Two of the members must be past or present parent users of the Program. All parents whose child/children attend the GRASP program are members of the corporation and are eligible to run for the Board of Directors. Representatives from the community are also eligible for election.

The Directors are elected each year by the members of the corporation. Elections for Members (including the Executive Members) are held in the summer each year at an Annual General Meeting (AGM) of the Corporation which current Board Members, GRASP staff and parents are expected to attend. Each family has one (1) vote.

Board Meetings are held once a month at Greenland Public School. The Executive Director (ED) of the program, who is responsible for the decisions governing the day-to-day operation of the program, also attends these meetings to present a review of activities/concerns over the past month and discuss these with the Board. This process serves to check whether the objectives of the program are being met, as well as to provide an opportunity for the Board and the Executive Director (ED) to resolve matters of concern regarding the overall operation and financial viability of the program.

### **Participation & Communication**

GRASP is a school age program with a 1:15 ratio. Children and families enrolling in GRASP must have the developmental capabilities to participate in the program. As school ages children that are developmentally capable, we will share information and give directions during class time to share with families with regards to happening with in the classroom and program. It is the children’s responsibility to follow through with directions and inform parents.

|          |
|----------|
| Initials |
|----------|

Vital information will be directly communicated to parents. Staff is not responsible for lost belonging. Children are responsible to dress themselves and suffer the natural consequences of their dictions. Staff will not force a child to do homework, dress for the weather or other, staff will encourage, explain natural consequences, and assist to advise child to make the best decision for themselves. Staff is expected to enforce rules for safety of everyone with in the program.

To help our environment and support our community in reducing waste, GRASP main communication method is email. Hard copy of all paperwork is available up on request for all families.

All documentation has a due date that is required from the office in order to run the program to optimum abilities. All forms that are late will be considered but will not always be accommodated. Due dates are firm and are put in place for various reasons and parameters. All families are expected to follow and respect these guidelines.

To facilitate ongoing parent involvement and communication, GRASP staff is available at the beginning and end of each day for short update on how their child day was. Parents can contact the Executive Director, to make an appointment to see him/her or staff when they are not in ratio, for more detailed information or discussion if they have any queries, problems or concerns regarding their child/children or the Program.

There is also a Parent Information Notice Board with posted information regarding the Program's daily activities, weekly plans snack menus, Meeting Notices, etc.

The GRASP Board of Directors encourages input to running the program in a positive productive manner. Parents' questions, suggestions and comments are always welcome and can be relayed through the Executive Director, in writing to the Board.

The GRASP issues regular email updates which contain information about the Program's activities and plans, reminders of certain policies and practices of GRASP, notices of forthcoming events and other information. Parents can participate in the Program by helping with Fund-raising ventures, volunteering their time to help on trips, joining the Board, helping with Arts and Crafts programs or sharing any special skills or knowledge.

**Hours of Operation**

GRASP is a before and after school program which operates five (5) days per week, Monday to Friday from 7:30 AM to 9:00AM and 3:00 PM to 6.00 PM during the school year and 7:30 AM – 6:00 PM during the summer program and non-instructional days.

We are closed on the following holidays:

|                |               |               |               |                     |
|----------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------------|
| New Year's Day | Easter Monday | Civic Holiday | Christmas Day | <div>Initials</div> |
| Family Day     | Victoria Day  | Labour Day    | Boxing Day    |                     |
| Good Friday    | Canada Day    | Thanksgiving  |               |                     |

Please note GRASP closes early on Christmas Eve and New Year’s Eve. If Christmas or New Years falls on a Sunday, GRASP will close early on the Friday immediately prior to that Sunday.

Parents will be notified in advance if GRASP must close any additional days due to Board of Education policy. Due to safety reasons, once your child’s class/group has left the center for a walk or field trip, staff is not permitted under any circumstances, to release or accept your child off of school property. You must drop off or pick up your child before or after the walk or outing.

GRASP services a number of schools in the Don Mills community. GRASP is located in a Toronto District School Board school and follow the holidays, P.A. days and P.D. days as set out by the TDSB. If your child attends a school with non-instruction days that differ from the TDSB, we **will not** be able to accommodate children and busing on those days.

**Emergency Closure Policy and Procedure**

GRASP will strive to operate during severe inclement weather. However, as we are located on the Toronto District School Board property, we must follow procedures set out by the Toronto District School Board. GRASP will be closed if the TDSB is closed due to inclement weather.

GRASP must close if Greenland Public School is closed. As we may not have access to the building, families will receive an email that will be updated as we have the information given to us. You will also receive information via the media, radio, and television, as to school and childcare closures.

**Power Outage:**

If severe weather (or any other cause) creates a power outage or flooding, GRASP may be required to close. Parents will be notified by telephone and will need to pick up their child/children as soon as possible. As we may not have access to the building, families will have to telephone the Centre and listen to the automated messaging system. You will also receive information via the media, radio and television, as to school and childcare closures.

#### Heating Failure:

If the childcare center is not being heated, due to a breakdown of the boiler in Greenland Public School or the heating system in the portable, GRASP may be required to close. Parents will be notified by telephone and will need to pick up their child/children as soon as possible.

#### Medical:

In the event of closure due to a medical reason such as an outbreak, GRASP will follow the direction of the Toronto Public Health parents may be notified by telephone and may need to pick up their child/children as soon as possible.

#### Strikes:

If the teacher's union or support staff with the Toronto District School Board decides to strike during contract negotiations, GRASP may be required to close. Parents will be notified in by email or by telephone as information becomes available.

#### Refund of Fees:

Childcare fees will not be waived or prorated due to an emergency closure and/or as described in this section for closures of up to a week (5 business days). After this period, the Board of Directors will meet to review the situation and to assess how long the closure might continue and whether any fee adjustments are warranted. This does not imply that fees will be refunded for closures that are longer than a week.

Initials

#### **Admission Requirements and Procedures**

GRASP is licensed to admit children 5 1/2 – 12 years of age, and has a capacity of 63 children, although GRASP only admits children from Grade 1- 5 only as that is the age group of the children served at Greenland Public School. Special consideration will be given to children after grade 5 based on written request from the parent at the discretion of the Executive Director. Admission of new children is done by the Executive Director based on a waiting list established in accordance with the following priorities:

- Children attending Greenland Public School.
- Siblings of children currently enrolled in the Program.
- Children who live/attend school in the Greenland Public School attendance area.
- People who work or live in the Don Mills community.

Once a wait list form has been completed, your child/children's names will be added to the waiting list in sequence to the date of application and in accordance with the above priority criteria and families will be notified once space becomes available. Your child/children's space(s) is confirmed once all necessary forms and documentation is completed in full and fees are received.

#### **Registration, Fees & Deposits**

Upon registration with the program, a ***non-refundable*** administration Fee of \$25.00 (per child) is required

##### **School year:**

***Deposit of 50%*** of the monthly fees based on the full fee rate  
first month's fees of care  
post dated cheque for the remainder of the school year

##### **Summer camp:**

2 weeks deposit based on camp rate fees  
post dated cheques for the 1 of each month to include all fees for that month

Refunds or credit that are a result of over payment or change of fees will be refunded to within 90 days of adjustment.

Methods of payment accepted are cheque and Money order. We discourage cash payment and EFT, but will accommodate requests

Deposits will be refunded after the child's last day in care provided a minimum of one month's notice (30 DAYS) is given in writing to the Executive Director and all balances are paid in full. Failure to provide this notice will result in forfeiture of the deposit. This deposit is required prior to a child placement into the program. There will be no reduction of fees for statutory holidays or occasional absences. Fees are subject to change. Parents shall be given one month's notice of any fee changes. Summer Camp registrations are final, and no refund will be given after the final commitment date of May 15.

The following is the fee schedule for GRASP:

- September to June a monthly fee charged based on fee schedule
- An additional fee is charged for non-instructional days based on the fee schedule. All families are required to confirm enrollment on all non-instructional days if you wish for your child to attend the program. **Families who do not confirm enrollment on non-instructional days by returning the forms issues by the designated due date, fail to be registered and will not be accepted into care on that day/s.**
- July-August Summer Program has its own cost depending on the program run that year. A separate deposit will be required for the summer along with the appropriate fees. Summer fees are prepaid by postdated cheques date for the first of the month. If paying cash or EFT fees must be submitted by the Friday 12 noon before care on Monday.

Initials

All fees must be paid by the 26th the previous month for the upcoming month to allow time for processing. The preferred method of payment is post-dated cheques for the school year. The Centre also accepts e-transfers and cash if necessary. Receipts will be given for all cash at the time of transaction. Non-payment of fees by the 6<sup>th</sup> will result in a \$25.00 late fine per month and possible withdrawal of care.

Providing your account is up to date, and one month (30 day) written notice of withdrawal is given to management, your deposit will be refunded or credited. If any post-dated checks are on file, they will be returned or destroyed. Registration fees are non-refundable.

If an account is past due after the 15th of the month and a payment plan is not in effect, the program may choose to withdraw your child unless you are otherwise notified. If payment is missed from a payment plan, GRASP reserves the right to withdraw the child from the program.

Please note that a \$30.00 administration charge will be applied for N.S.F. cheques. Parents will be required to resubmit money order, certifies cheque, cash or EFT with the penalty charges added. Should your child be removed from the Program for any reason and then re- admitted a re-registration fee applies.

***Please make all cheques payable to "GRASP"***

Income tax receipts will be issued before the end of February.

## **E-Transfer (EFT) Payment**

GRASP accepts **e-transfers (EFTs)** as a payment option for childcare fees. To ensure payments are processed correctly and securely, please note the following:

- All e-transfers must be sent to the **Centre's official email address.**
- Parents must sign and acknowledge the EFT form
- Please **include your child's full name** in the message or memo section when sending EFT.
- Payments are **due by the 26th of each month** for care in the following month.
- Payment is not considered complete until the funds are **received and deposited by GRASP.**

- Parents are responsible for any misdirected or incomplete transfers.
- At this time, there are **no fees** for using e-transfers; however, if fees are introduced in the future, parents will be responsible for those costs.
- Be aware of **fraud and scams**. GRASP will **never email or text** asking for passwords or banking information.
- If there is ever an issue with a payment, **management will contact you directly** by phone or in person.

Thank you for helping us keep payments secure and timely.

A family that has **more than one child** in the Program will be given a 5% family *discount*. **This is for full fee families, during the school year only. Families who are eligible for CWELLS are not eligible for the family discount.**

Effective January 1, 2026, each child with a fee subsidy is allowed up to 50 absent days per calendar year (25 absent days for admissions after June 30th. The parent/guardian is responsible for the assessed fees set out by subsidy. If the child is absent for more than 50 days, the parent/guardian is responsible for paying the full cost of care. Statutory holidays will be excluded from the 50 days.

Requests for additional days of absence, beyond the 50 allowable days may be approved by the TCS District Supervisors for an additional 15 absent days with supporting documentation. Appeals will be considered for exceptional cases only, such as when a child has a documented special need or serious illness. Consequently, GRASP is requiring that you pay a two week's full fee deposit once your child has been absent 45 days. If and when you reach the 50 days, the center will start to deduct your fees from you deposit and request a further deposit if necessary. GRASP has the right to cancel care for your child if you refuse to pay the deposit or daily fee promptly. **Please note subsidy only allows 20 days of consecutive absences.**

### **Admissions & Withdrawal**

Prior to enrolling a child into GRASP, the Executive Director will a schedule meeting with parents/guardians to discuss all aspects of the daily program. These discussions will help determine if the program meets the families and child's needs.

Executive Director will meet the parents/guardians with their child/ren for a tour of GRASP as requested by either party. Subsequently parents will be emailed Center's Enrollment package to fill out at home and GRASP's Client Handbook to read and sign.

Prior to enrollment all children must have a complete file with the requested forms before starting and fees must be paid in full or a document payment plan must be in place.

Executive Director will meet with the parent/guardian in order to review and complete enrollment package.

This includes:

- Ensuring detailed information in the enrollment forms is completed in fill.
- Ensuring all consents are well understood and signed.
- Reviewing of the Parent Handbook.
- Submitting child's immunization record/ medical Information and Requirements.
- Informing the parents about the GRASP's withdrawal procedure

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Parents/guardians are encouraged to ask questions regarding the placement and the GRASP.

GRASP supports the inclusion of children with extra support needs; however, in the event that the center exceeds the natural proportion of children with extra support needs to the extent that it impacts service delivery, the Executive Director may not be able to admit additional children with extra support needs.

GRASP requires 30-day **WRITTEN NOTICE** be given to the Executive Director **prior** to a child being *withdrawn* from the Program. Notice will apply from the date the Executive director receives the notice. Fees will be prorated as needed. Once this letter is submitted the notice is final. Parents failing to give thirty 30-day notice are subject to payment in lieu of notice from the date of notice of withdrawal. Failure to submit proper notice will result in a forfeit of the deposit.

Once enrolled, if the program is having difficulty supporting the child's needs, staff will work with the family and support services to ensure that a child's extra support needs are met. However, it may be determined that the program is not an appropriate placement for this child. This decision will be discussed in consultation with the parents, the Executive Director, Board of Directors and may involve the Children Services Consultant and Special Needs Resourcing Services. It is recognized that all parties may not be in agreement, however GRASP will make every effort within the Centre's capacity to support the family in making suitable alternative arrangements.

The procedures will include:

- documentation (observations, incidents, meeting and use of support services)
- supporting the needs internally
- advising parents of concerns and working together/ review code of conduct
- advise parent of other options and resources available
- invite in Resource Consultant and notify children's services consultant and BOD
- create a plan that work for everyone to meet the child needs is possible
- Executive Director (ED) will refer the family to other childcare programs.

Parents/Guardians must agree to work together to meet the child's needs. Services may be recommended and advised to be put in place by the resource consultant in a timely manner. Parents/Guardians must agree to be involved by attending any required meeting and providing input. As a parent you will always have the final decision but keeping an open mind and positive communication is key. Together we all will determine the individual child's needs and lay out an action plan.

Parents will be notified when the recommendation for withdrawal is given to the Board and the parents will be able to attend a meeting of the Board of Directors in order to put their position forward. In special cases the Board reserves the right to have a child withdrawn immediately.

GRASP reserves the right to withdraw a family from care with 2 weeks' notice, if the parent(s) do not fully carry out the parental responsibilities as set out in the Parent handbook, and code of conduct; or such as interferes with and disruptive behaviour within the program, or daily operations of the Centre; or behaviour that is harassing, intimidating, or of an abusive nature to staff, other parents and/or the children of the Centre. GRASP serve the family, not just the child. If the parents are not satisfied with service levels, even if the child is, GRASP reserve the right to sever notice.

### **Meal allergies and Anaphylaxis**

Parents are required to provide lunch for their child daily including non-instructional school days. GRASP is a nut aware environment. No NUTS are allowed. Sharing of food is not allowed due to allergies.

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**All lunches are required to be nut free** and free of any allergens known to the center. Parents will be made aware of any restriction upon registration as soon as GRASP is aware of them. An email will be issued along with a posting at the entrance to the room of any allergen other than nuts. All families are to refrain from bringing this allergen to the center.

Parents are required to follow the Canada Guide when prepping their child meal for lunch and it is highly recommended to include a variety from each the food groups. It is required that lunch be stored in an insulated container/bag.

G.R.A.S.P. will make every effort to have a nut-free environment, although we cannot guarantee a nut free zone at all time due to children providing their own food from home. No peanut/nut products will be used or permitted at the center (indoors or outdoors) at any time. Although products that may have been in contact with or cross contaminated with peanuts/nut products cannot be controlled.

Examples as such are:

- labels that state may contain traces of nuts, but no nut listed in the ingredients
- Tim Horton's etc...

If a staff observed a product that is part of the anaphylaxis plan, the staff will immediately ask anaphylactic child to move away from the area, ensure the child's health and safety first. Then secure the item while wearing gloves. Place it in a bag, tape it closed and dispose / secure of the item out of the child's vicinity and access. Staff will then wash hands with soap and water and advise any other persons who handled the allergen to do the same. Staff will then disinfect the area and rewash their hands. The anaphylactic child's guardian will be made aware of the incident. The family who introduced the allergen to the environment will receive a phone call and be provided a warning. If the situation happens multiple times it could result in suspension from the program.

If a child forgets their lunch the guardians will be called and ask to provide a lunch immediately. GRASP does not have any meal provision on location. The child can be given a fruit or cheese and crackers to tide them over till lunch arrive. A lunch must be brought to the centre by the guardian.

### **Access, Equity & Inclusion**

GRASP upholds and supports the right to equal access to the program without discrimination and regardless of ethnic origin, race, creed (religion), abilities/disabilities, family and/or socio-economic status. GRASP aims to include all children within our program and services including those children requiring extra support or having special needs. Our full access, equity and inclusion policy is available in the GRASP Policies and Procedures manual.

GRASP is committed to excellence in serving all clients including people with disabilities. We are committed to ensuring that participants and/or their parents/guardians with disabilities receive accessible programs and services with the same quality and timelines as others do, wherever possible. GRASP supports the full inclusion of persons with disabilities in all our programs and services as set out in the *Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms*, *Ontario Human Rights Code*, the *Ontarians with Disabilities Act* (ODA), 2001 and the *Accessibility of Ontarians with Disabilities Act* (AODA), 2005.

### **Emergency Management & Response**

In the event of a major emergency or evacuation GRASP will relocate to:

Don Mills Collegiate  
15 The Donway East  
416-395-3190

#### **Requirements regarding communications with parents**

- Parents will be notified via email of Emergency Situation or relocation and a note will be posted, if possible, on the portable door.
- Calls will be made once the emergency has been deemed under control by the Executive Director
- Parents should call into the GRASP voice mail following the emergency for further information as available from the TDSB, email the Director or check for email updates from the management team.

GRASP is required to follow Toronto District School Board required procedure along with Child Care Quality Assurance, Licensing Early Learning Division Ministry of Education and Toronto Children Services.

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When calling the parents, they will be informed of their child's safety, the location where they can pick up. The details of the emergency will not be discussed until the debriefing for parents.

### **Debriefing After the Emergency**

Parents will be debriefed after the emergency via email from the Board of Directors or the Executive Director of the Program. Information such as what happened and steps to move forward will be included.

### **How to resume normal operations**

Depending on the severity of damage, GRASP will make every effort to resume normal operations of the program. Mitigating factors that will have to be taken into consideration are:

Children and staff safety, Property damage, Relocation requirements as per Child Care Quality Assurance, Licensing Early Learning Division Ministry of Education and Toronto Children Services.

### **Part-Time Spaces**

Part-time care will be available at the discretion of the Executive Director (ED) and the Board of Directors, subject to availability.

### **Summer Camp**

During the months of July & August, the temporary admittance of summer campers, subject to the availability of space, shall be permitted. The summer program weekly fee will apply to all temporary summer campers along with the annual registration fee.

### **Wait List Policy**

GRASP maintains an ongoing waiting list for families that have children that attend Greenland Public School, as well as other schools within the Don Mills Community. Once a waitlist registration form has been filled out, your child(ren)'s names will be added to the waiting list in sequence according to the date of application and using the following criteria:

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- Children attending Greenland Public School.
- Siblings of Children currently enrolled in the program.
- Children who live/attend school in the Greenland Public School attendance area.
- People who work or live in the Don Mills Community.

If your child is granted a spot based on the center's needs and limitations, families (both subsidized and full fee) will be required to pay a \$25 registration fee per child, two-week deposit and the first month's fee. If the start date is not at the beginning of a given month, the first month's fee will be prorated. The two-week deposit will be applied to the family's last month fees once **30 DAYS WRITTEN** withdrawal notice has been given. (See withdrawal policy). While we will make every effort to accommodate your child by the date that care is needed, we cannot guarantee that a space will be available. Parents may request an update about their child's status on the waitlist in person or by phone. Information will only be shared with the parent whose names appear on the waitlist. GRASP will not share information with third party agencies. The visible wait list will be available to see in person. The Staff will cover the names of other children on the list to ensure confidentiality.

## **Safe Arrival & Dismissal Policy & Procedure**

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### **Purpose**

This policy and the procedures within help support the safe arrival and dismissal of children receiving care. This policy will provide staff, students and volunteers with a clear understanding of their roles and responsibilities for ensuring the safe arrival and dismissal of children receiving care, including what steps are to be taken when a child does not arrive at the childcare center as expected, as well as steps to follow to ensure the safe dismissal of children.

This policy is intended to fulfill the obligations set out under Ontario Regulation 137/15 for policies and procedures regarding the safe arrival and dismissal of children in care.

### **GRASP Responsibility**

GRASP will ensure that any child receiving care at the center is only released to the child's parent/guardian or an individual that the parent/guardian has provided authorization for pickup. The center will not release any children from care without supervision of a person 18 years of age or older.

GRASP is committed to ensuring the safety of all children enrolled in the program. Being a community based childcare center; we service approximately 2-4 different schools daily. This poses a busy arrival schedule after school.

Where a child does not arrive in care as expected or is not picked up as expected, staff must follow the safe arrival and dismissal procedures set out below.

In the absence of the Director, the designate is responsible for calling the school/parents to determine the whereabouts of the child.

### **Parents Responsibility**

- All parents must inform the childcare when children are absent.
- All parents must sign off on the acknowledgement that at times children may get dropped off directly at school and may not attend childcare in the morning.
- All parents will also be required to inform GRASP *in writing (electronically accepted)* if a child will be attending any after school programs or extra-curricular activities.
- If parents are picking up their child directly from school during the school day, the childcare must be informed, and staff shall document the absence in the communication book.
- At the beginning of the school year, parents of children attending/departing GRASP by means of school bus will be required to complete GRASP's "Busing Information and Consent Form". This will outline the bus information, expected pick-up/drop-off times and responsibilities in the case of missed or late buses.
- In the event that a child is absent from the after-school program management must follow the policy below

### **Accepting a Child Into Care**

1. When accepting a child into care at the time of drop-off, GRASP staff in the room must:
  - Greet the parent/guardian and child.
  - Do a visual Health check of the child.
  - Ask parents if there is anything new that we need to be aware of?

If the parent/guardian has indicated that someone other than the child's parent/guardians will be picking up, the staff should ask parent if the person is over the age of 18 and on the pick-up list. Remind them that ID is required and ask the parent/guardian to provide authorization for pick-up in writing (e.g., note or email). Remind parents "no authorization! no release of the child".

- Document the change in pick-up procedure in the daily written record.
- Sign the child in on the classroom attendance record.

### **When a child is absent**

- Where a child is not going to be attending childcare the parent/guardian must inform the childcare of the absence.
- This can be done by communicating this to the staff at pick-up time the night before, by calling the childcare and informing a staff member or leaving a voice mail, by sending an email to the childcare or by contacting the Director's phone or sending a text message.

### **Where a child has not arrived in care as expected in the afternoon**

Where a child does not arrive at the childcare center and the parent/guardian has not communicated the child being absent (e.g., left a voice message or advised the closing staff at pick-up), the staff in the classroom must:

- inform the Director (in the absence of the Director, the designated staff in charge must be informed) and they must commence contacting the child's parent/guardian no later than 3:30pm. The Director or designate shall call the child's parent/guardian. In the event that there is no answer, and no answering machine, the parent must be called a minimum of three times. If a work/school phone number is listed, it will be called. If the parent cannot be reached on a personal phone. If there is an answering machine, a message requesting a call back must be left for the parent.
- After 3 phone call to each parent # on file and an email attempt, and the parents have not informed the centre of the child's absence by 4 pm the child will assumed to be absent. A notation in the daily message book will be documented on the attempts to reach the parents to confirm child's attendance.

Once the child's absence has been confirmed, program staff shall document the child's absence on the attendance record and any additional information about the child's absence in the daily written record

### **Children attending GRASP from Greenland Public School:**

As we are located on the Greenland Public School property, children attending GRASP' will meet GRASP staff in and around door 5 upon the dismissal bell. School staff are expected to hand off children to childcare staff.

For rain days, children will be dismissed from inside the school and expected to go to their designated classrooms. For portable children they will meet GRASP staff outside the library door. If a child has not arrived at the program within 10 min of the dismissal bell, the ECE will inform management and they will check with the school administration for the child's whereabouts of the child (only if child was in care during the morning program)

If the child was present during school hours and did not report to GRASP the Director or designate will advise the school that the child did not report to GRASP. It will be the school's responsibility to take responsibility of locating the child, as they were the last legal Directors of the child.

A courtesy call will be made to inform the parents that the child has not reported to the program and advised them to contact the school. If a parent cannot be reached GRASP staff can assist the school in locating the child if ratio permits.

### **Children attending GRASP from Don Mills Middle School:**

Parents of children attending Don Mills Middle School will be required to sign a “Permission to Walk from School Unaccompanied” form. Children will be expected to arrive no later than 4:00 pm. If a child has not arrived by this time, the director/ designate must be informed. Staff will follow the above procedure for child **not arrived in care as expected** along with attempts to contact the school as well.

If the child whereabouts are unknown the serious occurrence steps for missing child will be followed.

### **Children attending GRASP by school bus:**

Staff will wait for the school buses according to their arrival times as outlined by the parents. Buses will be given a 15–20-minute leeway. After 15-20 minutes, the following emergency steps will occur.

Step 1 - Call bus company to find out if bus is late and child is on the bus.

Step 2 - Call parents on each # in file at least 3 times, including emergency contact.

If the child's whereabouts are still unknown or contact with parents cannot be made within 30 min, police will be notified and serious occurrence steps for missing child will be followed.

Staff are responsible for marking the children in as they take them to their designated class. If a child does not get off the bus as expected, the staff collecting the children must either inform the Director/ designate who will follow the above noted procedure for children **not arrived in care as expected.** Staff will attempt to contact school who has followed their safe arrival and dismissal policy and document the absence.

### **Attendance Procedures**

To ensure the constant safety of all children, the following attendance procedures are in effect at all times.

- All children must be accounted for after school.
- If a child has not come down from school 10 min after the dismissal bell notify Director
- Children coming down late from school should be escorted by school staff
- After transitions, an attendance check must be done by the staff to ensure that all children have moved from one area to the next
- The attendance form must accompany the children at all time as the group moves.
- Each child is on an attendance list is to be mark in/out daily by s a staff as they arrive and depart from the program.

Parents agree to always accompany their child to and from GRASP and notify staff verbally upon arrival and departure. It is the parents’ responsibility to inform all pick up and drop off persons of this procedure and ensure they make verbal contact with the staff. In the event that the child is not accompanied to GRASP by an adult, GRASP has no legal responsibility for the safe arrival of the of the child. Failure to inform staff of arrival and departure may result in notifying the authorities.

### **Temporarily unsupervised/ Leaving the room.**

Children from time to time require to go to the washroom or to their belongings hanging by the hooks. GRASP will allow children to go to use the facilities or put stuff away in their bags with the condition that they **MUST** ask permission to leave the room, write their name on the board/attendance and take a buddy with them. Any child not back within a reasonable time (10 min max) Staff will go seek out their whereabouts. If staff is unable to leave their post, they must radio for another staff’s assistance or take the children with them.

### **Releasing a child from care**

1. The staff who is supervising the child at the time of pick-up shall only release the child to the child's parent/guardian or individual that the parent/guardian has authorized
2. Where the staff does not know the individual picking up the child,
  - confirm with another staff member that the individual picking up is the child's parent/guardian/authorized individual.
  - where the above is not possible, ask the parent/guardian/authorized individual for photo identification and confirm the individual's information against the parent/guardian/authorized individual's name on the child's file or written authorization.

### **Where a child has not been picked up and the center is closed**

1. Where a parent/guardian or authorized individual who was supposed to pick up a child from care and has not arrived by 6:00 pm, staff shall ensure that the child is given a snack and activity, while they await their pick-up.
2. One staff shall stay with the child, while a second staff proceeds with calling the parent/guardian to advise that the child is still in care and inquire their pick-up time. In the case where the person picking up the child is an authorized individual; the staff shall contact the parent/guardian first and then proceed to contact the authorized individual responsible for pick-up if unable to reach the parent/guardian.
3. If the staff is unable to reach the parent/guardian or authorized individual who was responsible for picking up the child, the staff shall contact emergency contact person and move through the authorized pick-up list in child file until contact is made and notify Director
4. Where the staff is unable to reach the parent/guardian, or any other authorized individual listed on the child's file by 7:00 pm the staff shall proceed with contacting the local Children's Aid Society (CAS) 416924-4646. Staff shall follow the CAS's direction with respect to next steps.

### **Outdoor Time for Before- and After-School Programs**

As per the Early Year and Child Care Act 2014, before and after school programs must have outdoor time for at least 30 minutes included each day, weather permitting, and safety conditions apply. Please ensure your child is appropriately dressed for the weather and has the appropriate clothing (rain boots, hats, glove, coats) All children will be expected to participate in outdoor activities.

Weather permitting means the **absence of severe weather conditions**.

Severe weather conditions include the following:

- Extreme heat/humidity alert
- Extreme cold – temperatures of -15° C or colder or a windchill of -20° C or colder
- Poor air quality – air quality advisory has been issued
- Thunderstorm warning
- Tornado warning
- Winter and ice storms (heavy snow fall, hail, ice pellets, etc.)

### **Trips and Going off Site**

GRASP is an active program with outdoor and indoor activities. Our program consists of regular trips off premises during the summer and non-instructional days. We expect all our children to put their best foot forward and behave appropriately in the environment we are in. If a child attends the program and a trip is scheduled, it is expected the child be ready and prepared to attend the trip with the required items and belongings, including but not limited to packed lunch, dressed for the weather or location with appropriate safety measure for the weather (sunscreen, hats, boots, runners etc.) GRASP does not provide alternative care for children who do not want to participate in trips or outings.

All Students are expected to be on site at least half an hour prior to departure for all trips and off-site adventures. Times of departure are listed in the permission form, and it is recommended parents make note of all vital information. **All children who are not here half an hour prior to departure will not be accepted into the program.** The reason for this is to ensure all safety measures have been executed in a proper manor as required by the Centre, the City of Toronto Assessment of Quality Assurance and the Early Year and Child Care Act, 2014

We are extremely lucky to have access to the school yard and fields that include a baseball diamond, basketball court and a soccer field that leads into the valley, with a world of explorations and fun to be had. We also visit other local attraction such as shops of Don Mills and the library. Local outings may occur from time to time with or without prior notice and shall be deemed normal daily activity. Notices will be sent home with consent forms for special trips and events, which involve public or other motorized transportation for permission.

GRASP program plans contain age-appropriate activities in order to keep the children engaged and from time to time may engage in some age-appropriate risky play activities as promoted in childhood development. In order to fully appreciate the program and give all the children the equal opportunity to participate in the plan activities, **it is expected and highly recommended all children be in care no later than 9:30 am on non-instructional days such as P.A. Day and summer camp.** Any community outing or walks will not depart prior to 9:30 am. Once the group leaves the center for a walk, community outing or field trip, staff is not permitted to release or accept your child. You must drop off or pick up your child before or after the outing on Greenland property. Children will only be accepted in their designated classes for ratio and safety purposes.

### **Departure & Late Fees**

It is the parent's responsibility to notify GRASP staff if your child is to be picked up by some other than you. Parents are advised to make every effort to pick up their child on time, especially during a storm or inclement weather, as staff also need to get home to their families. Parents are encouraged to pick up their child by **5:45p.m.** so that the center can close promptly at **6:00 p.m.** **If you are at the premises after 6 pm you are considered late and late fees will apply.** Children must be accompanied by an adult when dropped off or picked up from GRASP. **Children are not permitted to be left alone to walk around the school or though the premises unaccompanied.**

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GRASP clocks are set to Eastern Standard Time and parents are encouraged to set their watches to match the portable clock. If there is one late pick up a verbal reminder of the policy will be given to parents from staff. Two late pickups, parents will be contacted by the Director via email and asked to make arrangements for someone else to pick up their child. If there are more than two late pickups in a month, the parents will be contacted by the Director and asked to find a solution to the late pickups or a more suitable daycare arrangement. Failure to pay late fees to staff within 5 days or make a payment plan and adhere to it, may result in suspension from the program. **no rebate on regular fees for the time your child is absent.**

Parents who are late picking up their children will be charged a **LATE FEE of \$10.00** for the first 10 minutes or part thereof **after 6:00 PM** payable directly to the Program staff in cash. After the first 10 minutes, a charge of \$1.00 per minute will be payable. Parents are required to sign the late form and adhere to the policy.

**Note:** Parents of the child are liable for any late fees owed. If a designated person of your choice picks up late and acquires a late fee, you, the parent, are responsible to pay this fee to the childcare staff on duty. Parents are responsible to collect this fee from a designated person if they wish, NOT THE CHILD CARE! If we do not receive a call from a parent by 6:00pm the following procedure will be followed:

- The staff will call the parents.
- If they are not able to contact a parent, they will begin to call authorized pick-up people or the emergency person listed on file.
- Messages will be left on any answering machine.

If your child is not picked up by 6:00pm, and no parent/guardian or emergency contacts can be reached, GRASP staffs are legally obligated, under *The Child and Family Services Act (CFSA) 1999*, to report the matter to Children's Aid Society of Toronto after an hour at 7:00 pm

Children will not be released in taxis or sent home with any persons except those designated. Arrangements can be made to allow another adult to pick up a child, providing that the Centre receives written notice or verbal permission. Proper photo identification will be required at time of pick up by anyone at any time including parents or legal guardian. A telephone call is acceptable if the parent's voice can be identified on the telephone. People who are picking up MUST BE of legal age (18 years of age or older). GRASP is required to release children to either Parent, unless a Court Order indicating otherwise is provided.

### **Supervision/ Unauthorized access**

All staff are to ensure that every child who is in attendance is always supervised by a paid staff member. No child is to be unsupervised unless they are going to the washroom with a partner. (2 at a time only) Students and volunteers are not to be left alone with children under any circumstance. GRASP has a buzzer system on door 6 for access to childcare. GRASP monitors door 6 only and will not grant access to unauthorized individuals. GRASP make every effort to monitor who is in the building but has no control of any other doors of the school. We ask everyone not to prop doors open or allow access to others from any other entrance of the school. All families are encouraged to use door 6 only to enter and exit the childcare.

### **Health Policy**

The child's Immunization Record must be provided, and the Executive Director (ED) informed of immunization updates so the record can be kept up to date.

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Children that are sick should not attend GRASP for their own protection, the protection of other children and staff. Any child who is too sick to participate in any indoor or outdoor activities must not attend. When a child is ill and cannot attend, GRASP staff should be informed by phone.

Any communicable diseases such as strep throat, mumps, chicken pox, whooping cough must be reported to GRASP as soon as possible so that we can notify other parents and take proper precautionary measures. It is the best interest of everyone that your child stays home and seeks a doctor's advice when he/she has one of the following symptoms: *a cold, sore throat, earache, discharge from eyes and ears, swollen neck glands, unexplained rash and skin eruptions or any communicable diseases*. In these cases, the child can return to GRASP accompanied by a doctor's note stating that the child is ready to come back and is not contagious. GRASP staff has the right to refuse care to a child who is too sick to be at GRASP. Public health regulations take priority in any communicable disease situation, as we must follow proper procedure. These procedures may not necessarily concur with the doctor's advice. A fever is the body's way to fight off infection or virus. Therefore, children with a fever (101.3 F or 38.5C) must not attend GRASP for their protection, the protection of other children and staff.

If a child should become sick while at GRASP, exhibiting signs of illness, excessive diarrhea and/or fever, parents will be called to pick up their child as soon as possible. Parents will be notified upon the first loose bowel movement and vomiting and will be asked to pick up the child upon the second one. In the case of diarrhea or fever, a child can return to GRASP 24 hours after the symptoms disappear. If a child has a fever of 101.3 F and 38.5C or more the parent of the child will be notified. In this case the child can return to GRASP 24 hours after the symptoms disappear. It is advisable that parents prepare and arrange for an alternate or emergency person who could pick up your child when you are unable to.

As part of the Parent Handbook the ***Parent agrees to pick up their child*** or have the child picked up by an *authorized person within one (1) hour after having been notified by telephone by GRASP Staff.*

### **Hazard Mitigation**

GRASP identifies, addresses or eliminates hazards that could cause imminent harm to individuals by conducting monthly Occupation Health and safety inspection and by daily ongoing surveillance and diligence observation of the program. Parents/guardians will be notified via email of any high-risk hazards and action that will be taken to mediate the associated risk.

### **Water Safety**

In accordance with the Ministry regulations, Grasp is prohibited from the use of and access to all standing bodies of water (e.g. ponds) and recreational in-ground / above-ground swimming, portable / “kiddie” / inflatable wading-type, and hydro-massage pools, hot tubs, and spas.

GRASP may use a public pool that is a “Class B” pool as defined in Regulation 565 and where:

- There is a qualified lifeguard(s) on duty at all times;
  - The rules of the public pool are followed;
  - The children are directly supervised by adults at all times
  - Ratios are maintained at all times in accordance with the DNA and as defined in Regulation 565;
- and
- Parents / guardians are advised of the field trip and have signed a consent form.

### **Change of Telephone No./Address or Place of Employment**

**It is extremely important** to inform GRASP of any telephone and/or address change at home or at work and also provide an up-to-date telephone number where you can be reached in the case of an Emergency.

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### **Accidents**

An Accident Report *will* be filled out by GRASP staff for all accidents outlining the circumstances of the accident, and any first aid treatment given. The report will be discussed with the parent upon pick up and any major accidents require a courtesy call to parents to inform them of what happened. The parent will be asked to acknowledge by signing the Accident Report and a copy will be kept on file.

### **Medicines & Medical Needs**

Only designated ECE staff is allowed to administer medication to the children, in accordance with the instructions on the label and the Parent/Guardian Authorization Form.

If prescription medication is to be administered to a child it must be in its original prescription container clearly labeled with the child’s name, the doctor’s name, the name of the medication, the dosage required to be administered, the expiry date and instructions for storage and administration. Medication will not be given to a child in milk or within food.

A Parent/Guardian Authorization Form must be filled out by the parent/guardian of a child for each new prescription before medication can be administered. The parent/guardian must give their child's ECE staff specific, written instructions consistent with the prescription including a written schedule for the administration of the medicine and a signed authorization form provided by GRASP.

*Emergency medication that can be considered life saving is permitted to be carried in the emergency back pack and must be accompanied by a signed medication form or by an emergency plan. Example Anaphylaxis plan or diabetes plan. In addition to emergency allergy and asthma medication, staff may carry medications for epilepsy and diabetes, as well as any other medication that a prescribing medical professional determines must be readily available to prevent a significant risk to the child's health. At this time children are not allowed to carry their own medication*

### **Behaviour Guidance/ Prohibited Practices**

At GRASP, the Staff provides a kind, understanding atmosphere involving methods and attitudes that help produce self-control and self-direction. In doing this the Staff meet all the requirements set out in the Child Behaviour Guidance Policy, specified by Child Care and Early Years Act, 2014 and Children's Services, which states that children should be encouraged to verbalize their aggression rather than resort to physical action, but they also need to know it is necessary to live with restrictions and limitations.

When a conflict arises, children are sometimes unable to express their emotions. At such times their attention needs to be redirected. If a child does resort to physical aggression/violence, and another child is involved, both children should be taken aside, and the situation should be discussed with them so they may gain an understanding of the problem. The staff provides help in directing behaviour in ways that are acceptable to others.

We feel that our major goal in the area of discipline is self-control; helping the child take steps toward responsible self-direction. All staff is required to use positive discipline methods. Disciplinary action will take the form of positive guidance, re-direction and the establishment of well-defined limits which will occur at the time of the incident.

In accordance with the Child Care and Early Years Act, 2014, the center will not permit, practice or inflict any form of the **Prohibited Practices** listed below:

The following are unacceptable behaviour strategies and are prohibited by employees, volunteers or students at any time under any circumstances;

1. Corporal punishment (physical punishment such as hitting, spanking, kicking, heavy pushing, shoving, grabbing, squeezing arms, ears, etc.);
2. Deliberate harsh or degrading treatment that would humiliate a child or undermine his or her self-respect;
3. Depriving the child of basic needs (i.e. food shelter, clothing, and bedding). Food should not be used to discipline children at lunch or snack time;
4. Locking the exits of the Centre for the purpose of confining the child; and
5. Using a locked or lockable room or structure to confine the child if he or she has been separated from other children.
6. Inflicting bodily harm or making a child eat or drink against their will
7. sexual abuse, sexual misconduct and prescribed sexual acts (as defined under the Early Childhood Educators Act, 2007) [Early Childhood Educators Act, 2007, S.O. 2007, c. 7, Sched. 8 | ontario.ca](#)

The Centre maintains a zero-tolerance approach to any form of sexual abuse, sexual misconduct, exploitation, or prescribed sexual acts involving a child. These behaviours are strictly prohibited under the **Child Care and Early Years Act, 2014 (CCEYA)**, and **Ontario Regulation 137/15 applicable legislation**, and this policy. Any allegation, suspicion, or disclosure of such conduct will be treated as a serious matter and will be addressed

immediately in accordance with the Centre's Child Protection Policy, Serious Occurrence Policy, Duty to Report obligations, and any other applicable legal or regulatory reporting requirements

Corporal punishment and other harmful disciplinary practices are forbidden to protect the emotional and physical well-being of children. These practices are never permitted at the Centre. Rather, the children benefit from an affirming approach that encourages positive interactions with other children and with adults, rather than from a negative or punitive approach to managing unwanted behavior.

**The following methods of direct and indirect discipline will be used:**

1. **Redirecting** (suggesting an alternative activity/space)
2. **Using positive statements** (*'I need you to sit on the chair'* instead of *'stop standing on the chair'*)
3. **Choices and Logical Consequences** (i.e. Lose the privilege of the activity for the day)
4. **Reasoning**
5. **Positive Feedback** (*'way to go'*, *'good for you'*, *'keep up the good work'*)

Initials

### **Personal Belongings/Toys**

GRASP is not responsible for the loss or breakage of any personal belongings or toys brought to GRASP. These are the responsibility of the parents and the child/children. All such items should be clearly marked with the child/children's full name. We ask that except for special days (check calendar/notice) that you refrain from bringing toys from home.

## **Legal Requirements Regarding Suspected Child Abuse**

### **The Child and Family Services Act (Section 72)**

Initials

### **Duty to Report**

In accordance with the *Child and Family Services Act*, it is the responsibility of every person in Ontario, including a person who performs professional or official duties with respect to children, to immediately report to a Children's Aid Society if s/he suspects that child abuse has occurred or if a child is at risk of abuse. This includes any operator or employee of a day nursery. An individual's responsibility to report cannot be delegated to anyone else.

Children Aid Society 416-924-4646  
Catholic Children Aid Society 416-395-1500

Jewish Children Aid Society 416-638-7800  
Native Child and Family Services 416-969-8510

### **Serious Accident/ Occurrences**

All licensed childcare programs are responsible for delivering services that promote the health, safety and well-being of children. Childcare operators are accountable to the public and the ministry to demonstrate that their services are consistent with relevant legislation, regulation and policies.

A serious occurrence is defined under the CCEYA as:

- the **death of a child** who receives childcare at a licensed home premises or childcare centre;
- **abuse, neglect or an allegation of abuse or neglect** of a child while receiving childcare at a home premises or childcare centre;
- a **life-threatening injury to or a life-threatening illness** of a child who receives childcare at a home premises or childcare centre;
- an incident where a child who is receiving childcare at a home premise or childcare centre goes **missing or is temporarily unsupervised**, or

- an **unplanned disruption of the normal operations** of a home childcare premises or childcare centre that poses a risk to the health, safety or well-being of children receiving care at a home childcare premises or childcare centre.

In a situation that is considered a serious occurrence, a report will be completed and signed and submitted to the licensing authorities as a form of notification.

### **Participation in The Program**

The GRASP Program incorporates a variety of activities to meet the physical, intellectual and emotional needs of the child/children. If a child is unable to participate in all facets of the Program the parent(s) should discuss the circumstances with the Director. Special consideration may be granted at the directors' discretion.

If your child is injured/ill at school and the school calls home, the parent must come pick up the children from the school. GRASP will not take children into care. Head injury will automatically be denied care.

### **Confidentiality**

Our GRASP will not release information about families and children enrolled to anyone. Confidentiality is followed in order to respect families' privacy. Staff and management and the Board of Directors understand that they will receive and have access to confidential information about children and their families. They agree to keep this information in the strictest confidence. Parents sign a consent form as part of the registration package to consent to sharing information with school, staff of the GRASP and the resource staff consultant.

### **Complaint and Conflict Resolution**

The purpose of this policy is to provide a transparent process for parents/guardians, the childcare licensee and staff to use when parents/guardians bring forward issues/concerns. This policy does not reflect situations of discrimination, harassment, and/or sexual harassment. A distinct policy exists for problems of that nature.

The needs of children and all members of the organization must be taken into account in the operation of GRASP at all times. Issues, concerns or problems may arise, from time to time, that require attention and resolution. The policy is to facilitate problem resolution as quickly as possible with due regard to the rights and responsibilities of those involved. It is the responsibility of the individual who has a complaint to initiate the process of resolution.

Procedures for initiating problem resolution and for lodging formal complaints are outlined below.

The Board of Directors is responsible for final decisions of complaints that are not resolved prior to being presented to the Board.

Parents/guardians are encouraged to take an active role in our childcare center and regularly discuss what their child(ren) are experiencing with our program. As supported by our program statement, we support positive and responsive interactions among the children, parents/guardians, childcare providers and staff, and foster the engagement of and ongoing communication with parents/guardians about the program and their children.

All issues and concerns raised by parents/guardians are taken seriously by GRASP and will be addressed. Every effort will be made to address and resolve issues and concerns to the satisfaction of all parties and as quickly as possible.

Issues/concerns may be brought forward verbally or in writing. Responses and outcomes will be provided verbally, or in writing upon request. The level of detail provided to the parent/guardian will respect and maintain the confidentiality of all parties involved.

An initial response to an issue or concern will be provided to parents/guardians within 2-5 business day(s). The person who raised the issue/concern will be kept informed throughout the resolution process. Investigations of issues and concerns will be fair, impartial and respectful to parties involved.

## **Complaints Addressed to Staff**

Discussions between parents and staff members must take place at an appropriate time and location, where confidentiality can be adhered to and the program will not be disturbed. The first priority for staff members on program as per the Child Care Early Years Act is supervising the children at all times. Anyone who has a concern or any parents, who would like to discuss an aspect of the program or their children's progress, is invited to call the Centre to set up an appointment for a meeting. Staff members on program are not to be removed from supervising the children under any circumstances.

## **Complaints Addressed to the Executive Director**

If a parent feels that staff does not adequately resolve his/her concerns, they then must approach the Executive Director or designate. Staff may direct the parent to the Executive Director if they feel that they are unable to solve the matter or if the matter should be addressed at management level.

The Executive Director will contact the person who made the "complaint," investigate the specifics of the "complaint" and make every effort to resolve the issue within 2-5 days. All communication will be documented and placed on file in GRASP office.

If, after addressing the issue with the Executive Director, the parent continues to feel that the complaint has not been resolved, he/she may ask, in writing, for the matter to be brought to the Board of Directors. The Executive Director may also advise the parent that the matter must go to the Board if the parent is not satisfied with the actions or response of the Executive Director.

The complaint may be addressed at the next scheduled Board meeting or if deemed urgent by the Executive Director, the matter will be brought to the Chair of the Board.

## **Complaints about the Executive Director**

Complaints that involve the Executive Director should be made to the Chair of the Board of Directors in writing and may be placed in the mailbox next to the portable door. The person making the complaint must include a phone number or other form of communication. The Chair will contact the Executive Director and try to resolve the complaint or if needed inform the rest of the Board of Directors. A written response will be provided to the person who made the complaint within two weeks.

## **Escalation of Issues or Concerns /Complaints Addressed to the Board of Directors**

Complaints made to the Board of Directors must be made in writing. The Board, collectively with the Executive Director, will make every effort to resolve the issue(s). During the course of discussion with the person making the complaint, the Chair or any Board member must remain neutral and ensure that the outcome suggested remains undetermined until the Board of Directors has met, and a relevant resolution is passed.

The Board of Directors will contact a Legal Counsel if deemed necessary.

A written statement providing the outcome of the Board's decision will be delivered promptly to the person who issued the complaint within a 2-week following the Board meeting.

## **Confidentiality**

Every issue and concern will be treated confidentially and every effort will be made to protect the privacy of parents/guardians, children, staff, students and volunteers, except when information must be disclosed for legal reasons (e.g. to the Ministry of Education, College of Early Childhood Educators, law enforcement authorities or a Children's Aid Society).

## Conduct

Our center maintains high standards for positive interaction, communication and role-modeling for children. Harassment and discrimination will therefore not be tolerated from any party.

If at any point a parent/guardian, provider or staff feels uncomfortable, threatened, abused or belittled, they may immediately end the conversation and report the situation to the Executive Director and/or licensee.

## Concerns about the Suspected Abuse or Neglect of a child

Everyone, including members of the public and professionals who work closely with children, is required by law to report suspected cases of child abuse or neglect. If a parent/guardian expresses concerns that a child is being abused or neglected, the parent will be advised to contact the [local Children's Aid Society](#) (CAS) directly.

Persons who become aware of such concerns are also responsible for reporting this information to CAS as per the "Duty to Report" requirement under the *Child and Family Services Act*

Initials

## Complaint Procedure

| Nature of Issue or Concern                                                                                                      | Steps for Parent and/or Guardian to Report Issue/Concern:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Steps for responding to issue/concern:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Program Room-Related</b><br>E.g.: schedule, indoor/outdoor program activities, etc.                                          | Raise the issue or concern to <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- the classroom staff directly or</li><li>- the Executive Director.</li></ul> for immediate attention. The Board of Directors will provide a written response to the parent or person making the complaint within two weeks of the Board meeting.                                              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Address the issue/concern at the time it is raised</li></ul> or <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- Arrange for a meeting with the parent/guardian within 2-5 business days.</li></ul> <p>Document the issues/concerns in detail. Documentation should include:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- the date and time the issue/concern was received;</li></ul> |
| <b>General, Centre- or Operations-Related</b><br>E.g.: childcare fees, hours of operation, staffing, waiting lists, menus, etc. | Raise the issue or concern to <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- the Executive Director</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- the name of the person who received the issue/concern;</li><li>- the name of the person reporting the issue/concern;</li><li>- the details of the issue/concern; and</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Staff, Executive Director-, and/or Licensee-Related</b>                                                                      | Raise the issue or concern to <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- the individual directly or</li><li>- the Executive Director.</li></ul> All issues or concerns about the conduct of staff, that puts a child's health, safety and well-being at risk should be reported to the Executive Director as soon as parents/guardians become aware of the situation. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>- any steps taken to resolve the issue/concern and/or information given to the parent/guardian regarding next steps or referral.</li></ul> <p>Provide contact information for the Executive Director if the person being notified is unable to address the matter.</p>                                                                                                        |

| Nature of Issue or Concern          | Steps for Parent and/or Guardian to Report Issue/Concern:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Steps for responding to issue/concern:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Student- / Volunteer-Related</b> | Raise the issue or concern to <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- the staff responsible for supervising the volunteer or student</li> </ul> or <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- the Executive Director.</li> </ul> All issues or concerns about the conduct of students and/or volunteers that puts a child's health, safety and well-being at risk should be reported to the Executive Director as soon as parents/guardians become aware of the situation. | Ensure the Executive Director is informed of the issue/concern within 24 hours or as soon as reasonably possible thereafter.<br><br>Ensure the investigation of the issue/concern is initiated within 3-5 business days or as soon as reasonably possible thereafter.<br><br>Document reasons for delays in writing. Provide a resolution or outcome to the parent(s)/guardian(s) who raised the issue/concern. |

Issues/concerns related to compliance with requirements set out in the *Child Care and Early Years Act., 2014* and Ontario Regulation 137/15 should be reported to the Ministry of Education's Child Care Quality Assurance and Licensing Branch.

Issues/concerns may also be reported to other relevant regulatory bodies (e.g. local public health department, police department, Ministry of Environment, Ministry of Labour, fire department, College of Early Childhood Educators, Ontario College of Teachers, College of Social Workers etc.) where appropriate

## Bussing

Given your written permission annually, GRASP will ensure your child is put on and received from the community school bus when it arrives at Greenland Public School Monday to Friday, not including PA Days, school holidays or days the school is not operational.

GRASP will not be accountable or responsible for the safety of your child when he/she is on the bus or if your child does not arrive on the bus. GRASP will only assume responsibility for your child once he/she has been received from the bus in the afternoon.

All children who are required to be put on a bus in the morning hours will be required to be at GRASP at least 15-20 minutes prior to the bus arrival for pick up. This ensures the time to follow safety protocol for everyone in the program.

GRASP staff will wait for the school buses according to their arrival times as outlined by the parents. Buses will be given a 15-20-minute leeway. After 15-20 minutes, the following emergency steps will occur.

Initials

- Step 1 call bus company to find out if bus is late and child is on the bus.
- Step 2 call parents on each phone number on file at least 3 times, including emergency contact.

If the child's whereabouts are still unknown or contact with parents cannot be made within 30 min, police will be notified and serious occurrence steps for missing child will be followed.

GRASP staff will accompany your child to school in a taxi if the bus is missed or does not show up by 9:00am. With your annual written consent.

If your child misses the bus and it is because GRASP staff was negligent in getting them to the bus at the scheduled pick up time, GRASP will absorb all costs in getting my child to school in a taxi.

Full responsibility for the cost of the taxi or staff fees after 9:00am if the bus does not show up at the scheduled time and no notification was given to GRASP to make alternate accommodations will lay with the parents.

GRASP will make any and every effort to resolve any situation at minimal disruption to the day for parents and the program. Please be courteous and advise your child's school and Bus Company that your child attends GRASP and that we should be notified of any change or delay in the busing schedule as soon as possible, although ultimately it is the parent's responsibility to notify GRASP of any changes in schedule and of any absence by 2:30 pm daily.

## **Code of Conduct**

### **Introduction**

- A positive and respectful environment is essential to the wellbeing of children, parents, and staff.
- All students, parents, and staff have the right feel safe at GRASP. This requires that everyone is held accountable for their actions that may compromise the safety of students, parents, and staff.
- This code of conduct applies while on GRASP property, on field trips/off premises and during any other program-sanctioned activities offered by GRASP.

### **Definitions**

“Harassment” is a form of discrimination and is defined in this policy as any course of conduct or comment that is related to any of the discriminatory grounds contained in the Ontario *Human Rights Code*. These grounds include race, ancestry, place of origin, colour, ethnic origin, citizenship, creed, age, record of offenses, marital status, same-sex partnership status, family status, religion, sex, physical or mental disability; and is offensive to any person; and is known or ought to be known to be unwelcome.

Examples of harassment include:

- Verbal abuse or threats;
- Unwelcome remarks, jokes, taunting about a person's body, attire, age, ethnic or national origin, religion, sexuality, etc.;
- Practical jokes which cause awkwardness or embarrassment;
- Leering or gestures;
- Display of pornographic, racist or other offensive or derogatory pictures or other material;
- Unwelcome or unwanted behaviour such as pinching, brushing up against, hugging, kissing,
- Fondling or any other similar physical contact normally considered unacceptable by another

### **Guiding Principles**

- GRASP does not tolerate any harassment, violence or unsafe behaviour.
- All members of the GRASP community are entitled to be treated with respect.
- Everyone has a responsibility to resolve conflicts in a civil and respectful manner.
- Everyone is expected to resolve conflicts without using aggression.
- Everyone should be aware of their rights and accept responsibility to protect their rights and the rights of others.

### **Standards of Behaviour**

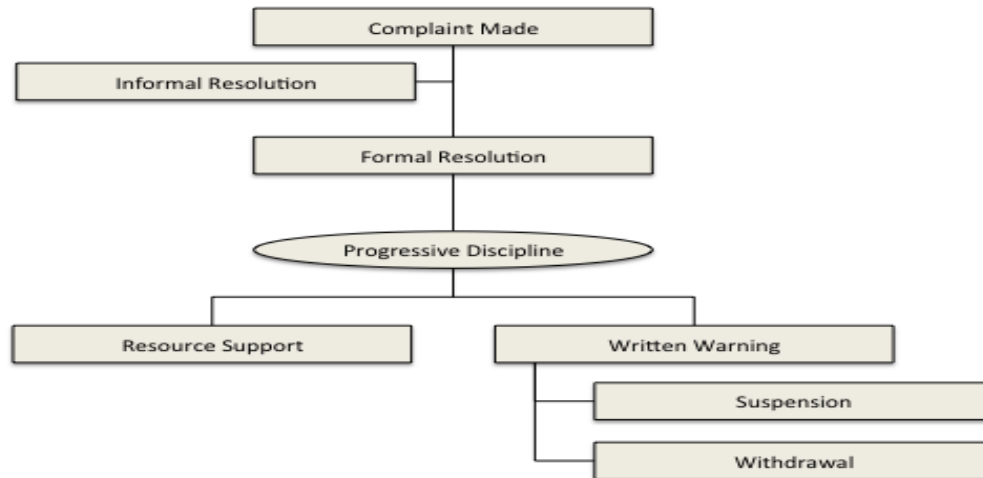
**All members of the GRASP community (children, parents, and staff) must:**

- Respect and comply with all federal, provincial and municipal laws;
- Demonstrate honest and integrity
- Respect differences in people including their ideas and opinions

- Treat one and other either with dignity and respect at all times
- Show proper care and regard for GRASP property
- Respect persons all persons, especially those who are in a position of authority
- Seek staff assistance to resolve conflict peacefully
- Not cause injury to any persons with or without an object
- Not inflict or encourage others to inflict bodily harm to another person
- Not swear at community member

## Enforcement of Code of Conduct

Depending on the severity of the conduct and the number of past similar occurrences, disciplinary action may call for any of four corrective steps:



Resource support, written warning, suspension, or withdraw from the program. Except for withdrawal from the program, any step of the disciplinary procedure may be bypassed or repeated more than once, if necessary, at the Director's discretion.

### Informal Resolution:

Depending upon the severity of the conduct, staff will firmly state that the behaviour is not tolerated according to the Code of Conduct listed herein. The expectation is that with a reminder of the Code of Conduct, the behaviour will not be repeated and the process will be resolved.

Should the process not be resolved a formal complaint will be made.

If the incident has happened on more than one occasion or is serious in nature, a formal complaint will be made.

### Formal Complaint:

The Director will discuss the incident with the parent. During this initial call, the Director will provide verbal information containing details of the incident(s) (i.e. what occurred, when it occurred, where it occurred and why it is unacceptable). Complaints will be dealt with in a confidential and expeditious manner. Confidentiality will be maintained throughout the process to the extent practical and appropriate under the circumstances.

## **Progressive Discipline Stages**

Our progressive discipline policy is based upon a 4-stage system as follows:

### **Stage 1: Resource support**

When incidences have occurred that warrants resource support under this policy, the Director will bring the incident to the parents/persons attention.

The Director and the parent/person will discuss the concerns and agree on action plan.

The Director is expected to follow-up with the parent/person and resource worker to ensure the action plan is effective and the desired results are achieved. If the desired changes or results are not achieved after a reasonable period of time, then a Written Warning may be implemented.

### **Stage 2: Written Warning**

Written warnings are used for behaviour or violations which an Executive Director considers serious or where a resource support has not helped to change unacceptable behaviour (or has not been implemented by the parent).

The parent/person will be given a letter indicating the severity of the problem, expected course of action by the parent and/or child, and the consequences of any future violations (e.g., suspension, withdrawal). The Director will inform a board member of the letter being issued.

### **Stage 3: Suspension**

Suspensions will be implemented when Written Warning has not resulted in behaviour change or there has been failure to comply to the actions listed in the Written Warning. The suspension will be given with conditions to return to the program. The fact that a suspension has been imposed will be confirmed in writing to the parent/person and placed in the file related to the person. A Board member must sign the letter along with the Director.

For serious misconduct, earlier progressive discipline stages may be bypassed, and suspension may be imposed. The parent/person will be given a letter confirming the fact that the suspension has been imposed, the severity of the misconduct, expected course of action of the parent and/or child, and the consequences of any future violations.

### **Stage 4: Withdrawal**

Withdrawal from GRASP resulting from progressive discipline is typically implemented when serious safety concerns are present, behaviors occurred on multiple occasions, refusal to seek support as indicated in a course of action following a disciplinary matter, or when the use of discipline has failed to change behaviour.

The following page contains a working document to assist the Director and staff in determining whether suspension is an appropriate or necessary consequence.

**ACKNOWLEDGEMENT OF RECEIPT  
OF THE PARENT HANDBOOK**

I \_\_\_\_\_ have received a copy of Greenland Recreational After-School Program (GRASP) Parent handbook and hereby agree to comply with the policies and procedure therein, as well as any additional inserts and amendments provided. I understand that if I refuse to sign or by not compiling, my child's spot in the GRASP program may be compromised.

\_\_\_\_\_  
Signature of Parent / Legal Guardian

\_\_\_\_\_  
Printed Name

\_\_\_\_\_  
Date

\_\_\_\_\_  
Signature of Executive Director

\_\_\_\_\_  
Date